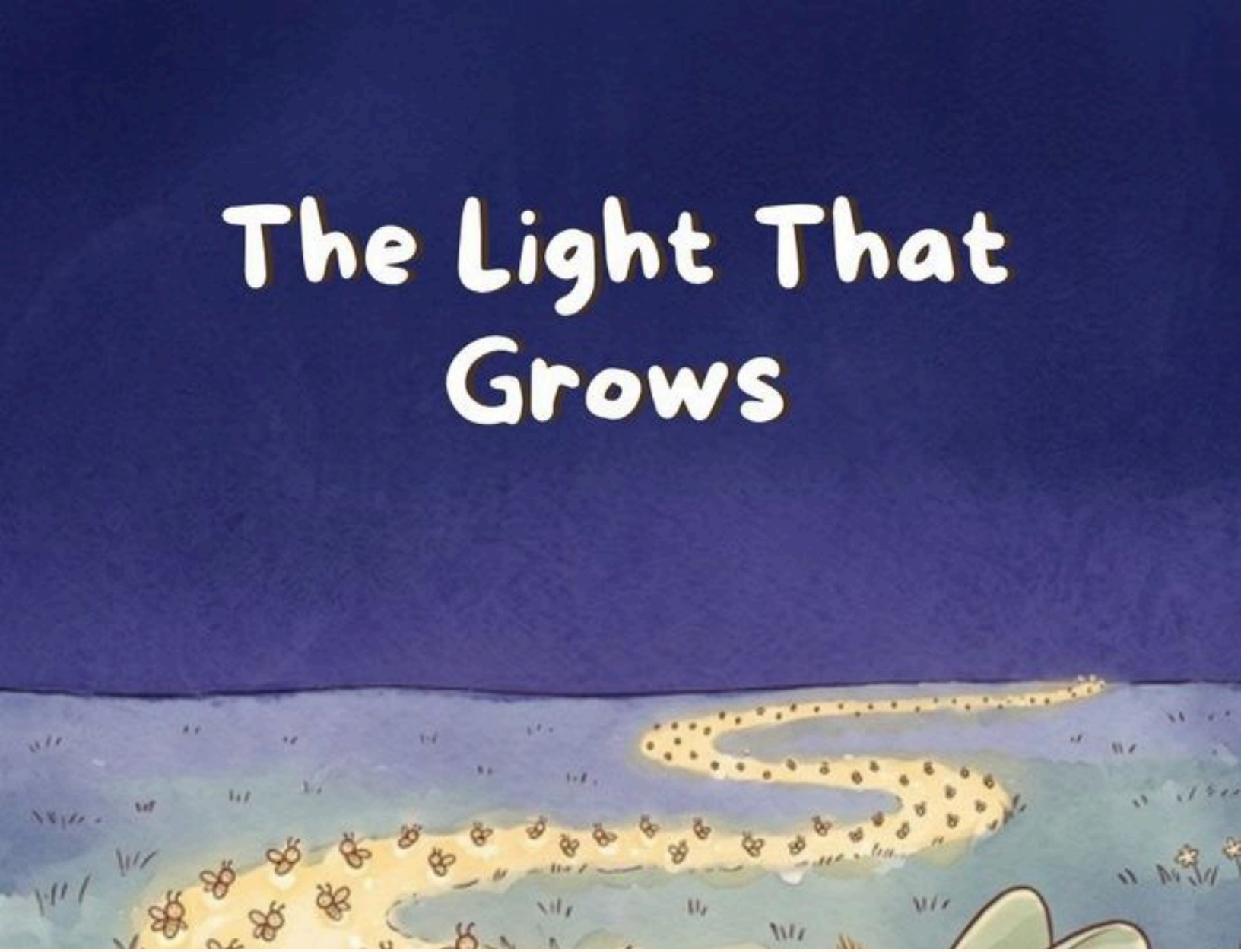


Classroom SEL pack, a week on kindness, ages 3 to 7

The Light That Grows

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Pass the light	Sit in a circle. One child holds a paper ‘glow’ and says one kind thing to the next child, then gives them a new glow from the basket. Keep going until everyone is holdin…	Page 8
Day 5 Kindness meadow	Kindness meadow, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a flashlight or battery tea-lights, yellow paper, a dark corner or blanket

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English, French, Spanish, German, Italian.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What is the little bug doing? Have you ever seen a firefly? Ask: What is something kind you can give a friend that doesn't cost anything? (A smile, a hug, a turn.) Take a few answers. Teach the sound: open and close your hands like blinking lights. 'Blink! Blink! Blink!'

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Old Glow: 'We will need every light.'	Why will the meadow need every light?	it will be very dark, no moon
5	Lumi hides her glow under a leaf.	Why did Lumi hide her light?	she was scared it would run out
6	The mice trip; the snail gets lost.	How did the meadow change when the fireflies stopped shining?	dark, everyone lost, tripping
7	Lumi's light feels small and cold. Lumi's light was safe.	Why did it feel cold?	she was alone, she wasn't sharing
9	Moss calls for Lumi; her wings tremble.	What will Lumi have to do to help Moss?	go out, use her light, be brave
11	A little firefly's light has gone out. Lumi is still afraid.	What do you think she will do?	share her light, help him
12	Flicker... FLASH! Lumi's light grows bigger.	What happened to Lumi's light when she shared it? Were you surprised?	it got bigger, not smaller
15	Everyone starts sharing what they have.	What did the other animals share?	a song, a nest, stories

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Some children worry about the dark. Keep the lights on during the dark-meadow pages if needed, and remind them the sun comes up at the end. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

glow

a soft, warm light

Do it: open and close your hands like a little light

firefly

a small beetle that makes its own light

Do it: flutter your fingers and blink your hands

fade

to slowly get dimmer and dimmer

Do it: close your hands slowly

hide

to put something where no one can see it

Do it: cover your hands

share

to give some to someone else

Do it: move your hands from your chest to a friend

Blink! Blink! Blink!

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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Some gifts grow bigger every time you give them away.

Blink! Blink! Blink!

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



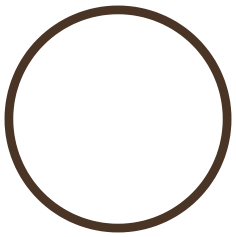
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Pass the light

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Paper fireflies, a dim room

Sit in a circle. One child holds a paper ‘glow’ and says one kind thing to the next child, then gives them a new glow from the basket. Keep going until everyone is holding a light. Notice: the first child still has theirs.

Kindness meadow

15 minutes, Individual, then whole class, Materials: Yellow paper circles, a dark paper meadow

Each child draws a kind act on a yellow glow and sticks it on the meadow. Add more glows all week as children notice kindness. Watch the meadow fill up.

Light and dark

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A flashlight, a blanket

Under a blanket, find a toy in the dark, then with the flashlight. Talk about how the animals felt in the dark meadow, and how the light helped.

Science and nature corner

Fireflies are beetles, not flies. They make their own light inside their bodies with a special mix of chemicals, and they flash to find each other. In the story Lumi shares her glow, but real fireflies can’t pass their light to each other, and it doesn’t run out like a battery: that part is make-believe. Moths fly at night but don’t glow. Fireflies need dark nights, damp grass and leaves to live, so outdoor lights left on can make life hard for them.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Lumi hide her light?

Look for: She was afraid it would run out like the others.

2. How did the meadow change when the fireflies stopped shining?

Look for: It got dark; the mice tripped and the snail got lost.

3. What made Lumi brave enough to come out of the log?

Look for: Hearing Moss call for help.

4. What happened to Lumi's light when she shared it?

Look for: It grew bigger and brighter.

5. What is a 'light' you have that you could share with someone?

Look for: Any answer: a smile, a game, help, a kind word.



Say it together

Blink! Blink! Blink!

The big idea: Kindness is a light you can share, and sharing it doesn't use it up. It makes more.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show kindness this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The meadow in the book has no name, so we picked the Sierra de Guadarrama mountains near Madrid. The Spanish moon moth, our pick for Moss, was first discovered here, and fireflies and glow-worms light up summer nights across Spain.



Portuguese firefly

Fireflies turn chemical energy into 'cold' light, losing almost none as heat.



Spanish moon moth

Scientists first described it from the Sierra de Guadarrama near Madrid in 1849.



Common glow-worm

Larvae paralyse small snails and then eat them, sometimes riding on the snail's back!



Great green bush-cricket

Bush-crickets hear with 'ears' on their front legs!



Wood mice

When something scares it, a wood mouse can leap high in the air.

Sierra de Guadarrama, Spain

Lumi: Real fireflies can't run out of light by sharing it, and they can't save it under a leaf either. Lumi's leaf hat is our artist's idea.

Moss: The book just calls Moss 'the moth'. We picked the Spanish moon moth because it's pale green and fluffy, just like him. Real moths can't glow, so that part is true!

Old Glow: A real glowing glow-worm only lives for a few weeks, so she could never be 'old' like Old Glow. And real glow-worms don't wear glasses or a shawl!

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-light-that-grows

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Use a real flashlight for light, dark, glow and fade. ‘Blink! Blink! Blink!’ is easy for everyone to join.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 5, 10 and 12). This book has 16 spreads; you can read it over two sittings, stopping after spread 9.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children keep a ‘light log’ for a week: one kind act given and one received each day, and notice how it grows.

Handle with care

Some children worry about the dark. Keep the lights on during the dark-meadow pages if needed, and remind them the sun comes up at the end.

Lumi is never shamed for being afraid. Keep that tone: being scared is okay, and she is brave anyway.

Kindness is not giving until you are empty. Lumi’s light grows; nobody has to give away everything they need.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. In Japan an old saying teaches that kindness to others goes around and comes back to you, and many traditions share the same idea: kindness that is given grows.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Light That Grows, a story about kindness. Lumi the firefly is afraid her light will run out, but when she shares it with friends who need it, her light grows bigger than ever. At home, ask your child about one kind thing they gave and one they received today. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu La lumière qui grandit, une histoire sur la gentillesse. Lumi la luciole a peur que sa lumière s'épuise, mais quand elle la partage avec des amis qui en ont besoin, elle devient plus grande que jamais. À la maison, demandez à votre enfant une chose gentille qu'il a donnée et une qu'il a reçue aujourd'hui. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre la bondad. Lumi, la luciérnaga, tiene miedo de que su luz se acabe, pero cuando la comparte con amigos que la necesitan, su luz crece más que nunca. En casa, pregunte a su hijo o hija por algo amable que dio y algo que recibió hoy. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über Freundlichkeit gelesen. Das Glühwürmchen Lumi hat Angst, dass sein Licht ausgeht, doch als es sein Licht mit Freunden teilt, die es brauchen, wird es heller als je zuvor. Fragen Sie Ihr Kind zu Hause nach einer freundlichen Sache, die es heute gegeben, und einer, die es bekommen hat. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sulla gentilezza. Lumi, la lucciola, ha paura che la sua luce finisca, ma quando la condivide con gli amici che ne hanno bisogno, la sua luce diventa più grande che mai. A casa, chiedete a vostro figlio o vostra figlia una cosa gentile che ha dato e una che ha ricevuto oggi. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

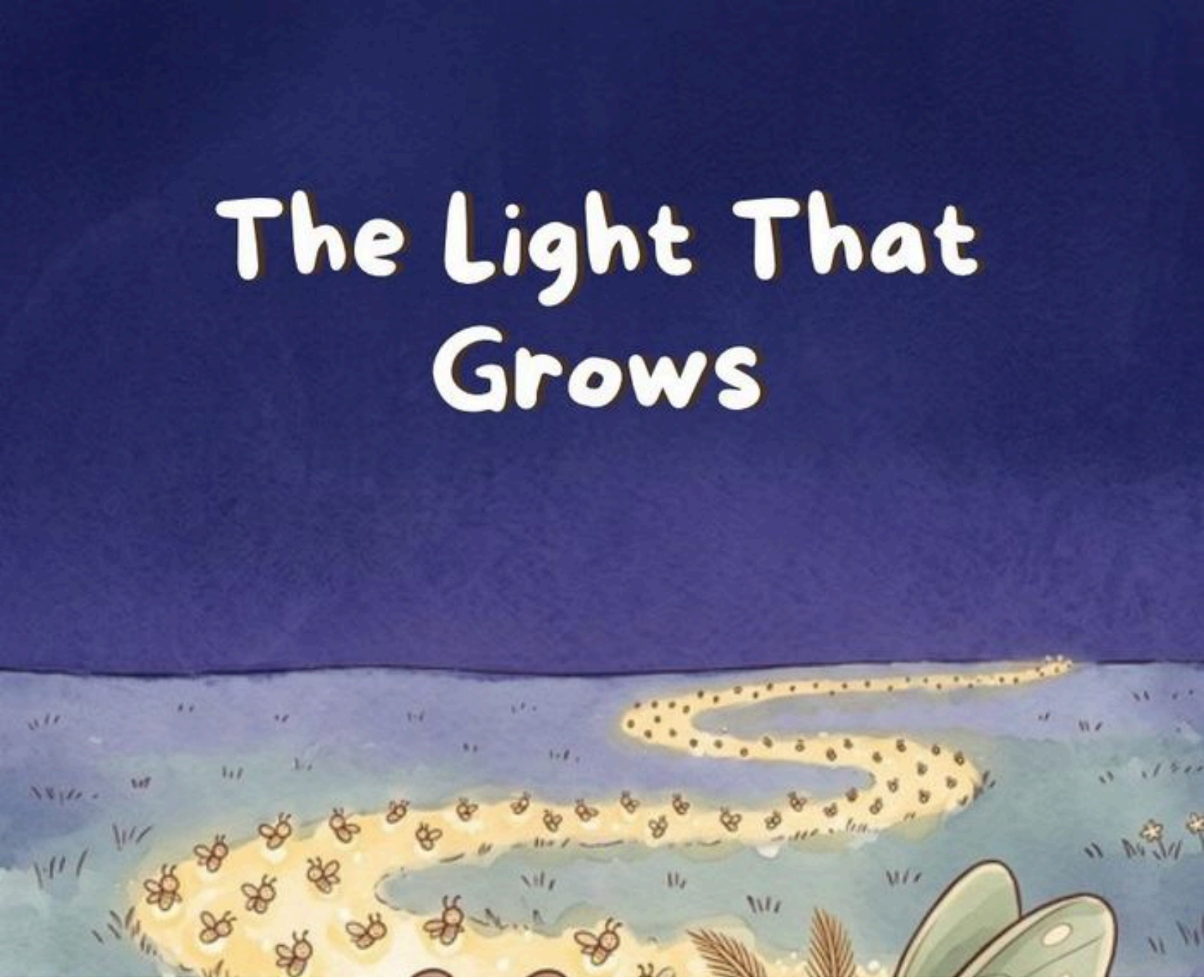
Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Light That Grows

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: kindness.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Kindness is a light you can share, and sharing it doesn't use it up. It makes more.

Say it together

Blink! Blink! Blink!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
glow	a soft, warm light	open and close your hands like a little light
firefly	a small beetle that makes its own light	flutter your fingers and blink your hands
fade	to slowly get dimmer and dimmer	close your hands slowly
hide	to put something where no one can see it	cover your hands
share	to give some to someone else	move your hands from your chest to a friend

A gentle note

Some children worry about the dark. Keep the lights on during the dark-meadow pages if needed, and remind them the sun comes up at the end.

Lumi is never shamed for being afraid. Keep that tone: being scared is okay, and she is brave anyway.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Lumi

Portuguese firefly

The smallest firefly, who learns her light grows when she shares it



Moss

Spanish moon moth

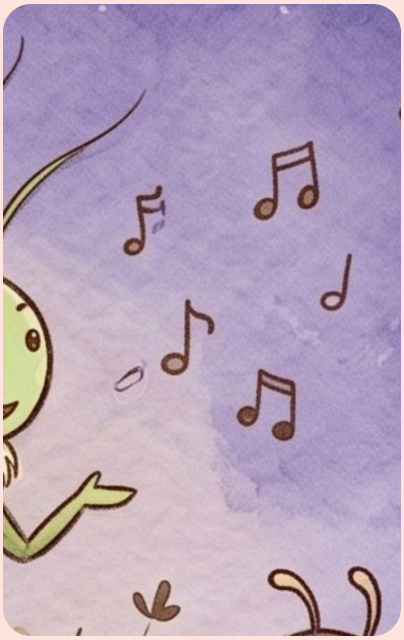
The best friend who can't glow but loves Lumi's light



Old Glow

Common glow-worm

The wise glowworm who calls the meadow together



The cricket

Great green bush-cricket

Teaches everyone his song



The mouse family

Wood mice

Find their way home by the lights

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How did they feel?

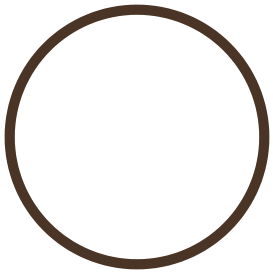
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Old Glow: ‘We will need every light.’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

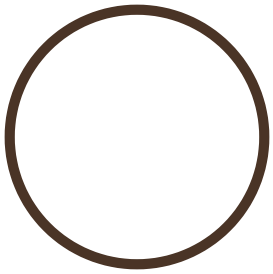


Moment 2

Moss calls for Lumi; her wings tremble.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

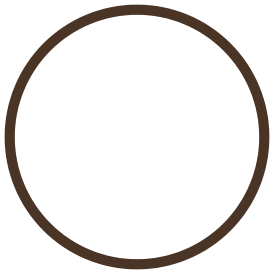


Moment 3

Everyone starts sharing what they have.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



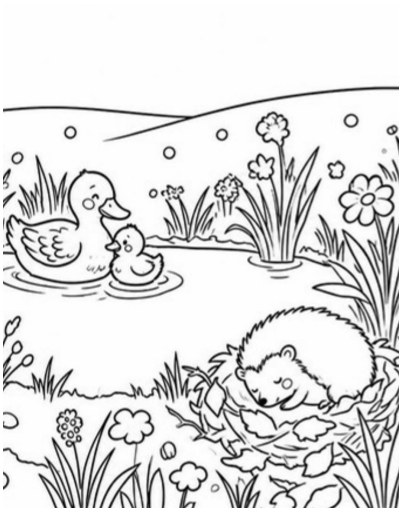
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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

glow a soft, warm light

glow glow

firefly a small beetle that makes its own light

firefly firefly

fade to slowly get dimmer and dimmer

fade fade

Lumi the hero of the story

Lumi Lumi

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Lumi showed kindness. Draw a time when you showed kindness too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Kindness meadow

You need: Yellow paper circles, a dark paper meadow

Each child draws a kind act on a yellow glow and sticks it on the meadow. Add more glows all week as children notice kindness. Watch the meadow fill up.

Firefly flash

In a dark room, flash a torch once a second, like a firefly. Can someone flash back?

Share the light

Light one candle with a grown-up, then use it to light another. Did the first flame get smaller?

Night sounds

On a summer evening, listen outside. Can you hear a cricket's song?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Light That Grows are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Lumi

Portuguese firefly

Fireflies turn chemical energy into 'cold' light, losing almost none as heat.



Moss

Spanish moon moth

Scientists first described it from the Sierra de Guadarrama near Madrid in 1849.



Old Glow

Common glow-worm

Larvae paralyse small snails and then eat them, sometimes riding on the snail's back!



The cricket

Great green bush-cricket

Bush-crickets hear with 'ears' on their front legs!

Story or real?

Real fireflies can't run out of light by sharing it, and they can't save it under a leaf either. Lumi's leaf hat is our artist's idea.

Where they really live

The meadow in the book has no name, so we picked the Sierra de Guadarrama mountains near Madrid. The Spanish moon moth, our pick for Moss, was first discovered here, and fireflies and glow-worms light up summer nights across Spain.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-light-that-grows

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the little bug doing? Have you ever seen a firefly?

The Light That Grows, talk card 1

Why did Lumi hide her light?

The Light That Grows, talk card 2

How did the meadow change when the fireflies stopped shining?

The Light That Grows, talk card 3

What made Lumi brave enough to come out of the log?

The Light That Grows, talk card 4

What happened to Lumi's light when she shared it?

The Light That Grows, talk card 5

What is a 'light' you have that you could share with someone?

The Light That Grows, talk card 6

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Kindness hero

This is to say that

_____

showed kindness, just like Lumi.

Blink! Blink! Blink!

Signed _____ Date _____

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